

SDC Data Visualization Guidelines

Working document

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2026-09-04

Colours

The palettes below are for **encoding data only** — bars, lines, pie slices, map areas. Colours for chart *elements* (axes, gridlines, labels) are handled separately, later.

Every palette is shown at **7 colours** so the full set is visible. In practice a categorical palette stays readable up to about **5–6 categories**; beyond that, colours become hard to tell apart, including for colour-blind readers.

Current palette

The categorical palette from the EDA strategy — our starting point and baseline for comparison.

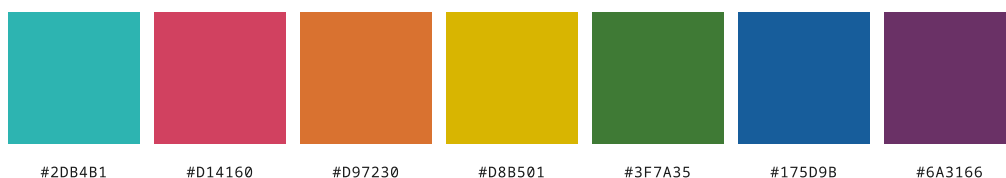


OKLCH

Built on a perceptual lightness staircase in OKLCH: same teal and pinkred anchors, with the light-pink and pure red swapped for a blue and a violet.

Pro: even lightness, more colour-blind-robust, works in black & white.

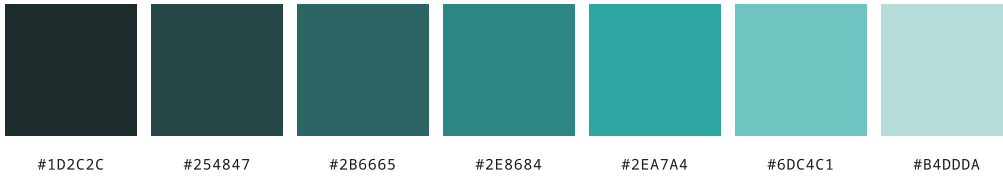
Con: slightly more muted — loses some of the current palette's .



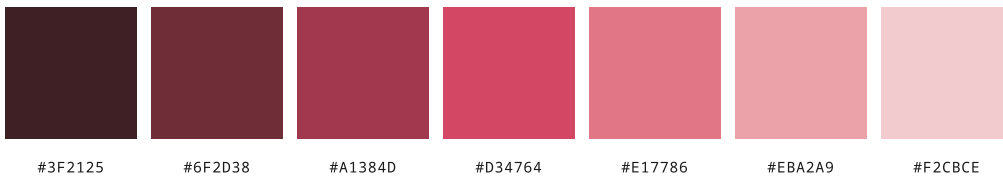
Sequentials

Sequential palettes based on the OKLCH approach for categorical.

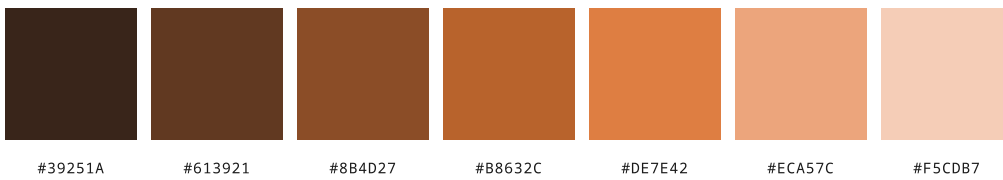
Teal



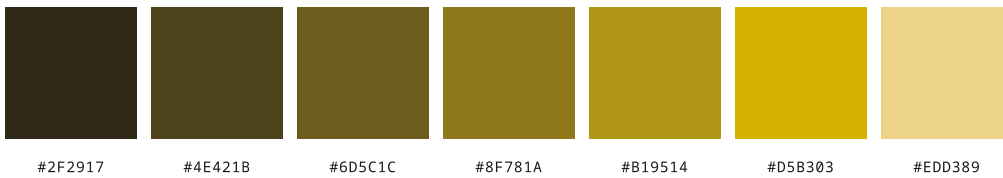
Magenta



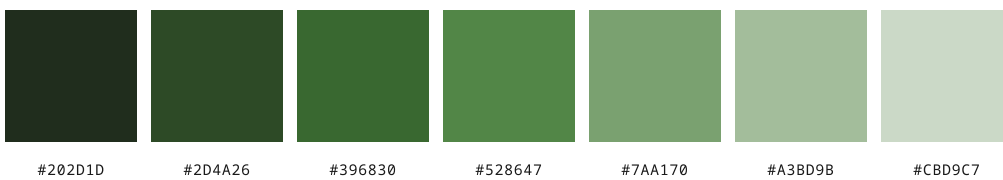
Orange



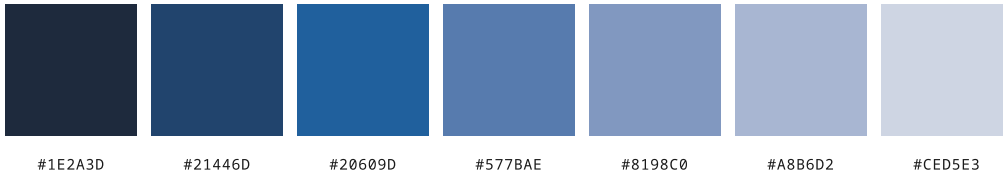
Yellow



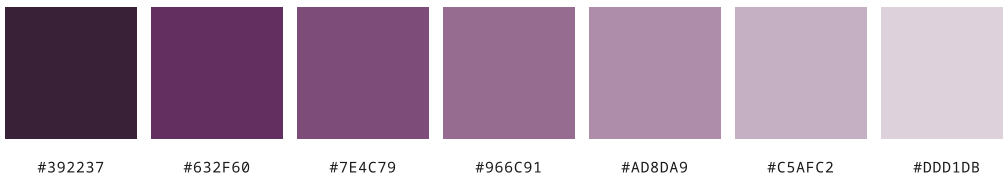
Green



Blue



Purple



Typography

Layout

Icons